A Morning at the Planetarium

Day 1 · Reading (1 of 2)

What to do: Read it aloud, one paragraph each. Stop at every blue word: can anybody explain it?

Vocabulary topic: Review: fear, science and space
20 new words (in blue) · EEW 1, Unit 1–3 · read a story that uses the words of Units 1–3 and talk about school trips



easy parts harder parts (most new words are here)

Last Friday our class went on a trip to a planetarium in Tashkent. We were all a little **nervous**, because our teacher, Mrs Karimova, told us it was a surprise. We did not know what to expect. The bus **arrived** at nine, and we were very early.

The building was big and round, like a huge white ball. Inside, it was dark and quiet. We sat in soft chairs and looked up. A kind voice said: “Welcome to the universe.” Nobody talked. There was only the sky, and it was not a real sky: it was a picture on the roof. But it looked so real!

First, the guide showed us the **planets**. She was an expert, and she could **describe** every one in a few words. Mercury was small and hot, Venus was thick with **clouds**, Mars was red and dry. “Are there **aliens** on Mars?” a boy asked. “Not yet,” she answered, and everybody laughed. Then she did something clever: she turned off all the lights, and for a moment we were in a real night with a thousand stars.

Suddenly there was a loud noise! A star seemed to fall straight at us. A girl screamed, and one boy tried to **hide** under his chair. Our teacher was **angry** at first, but then she laughed, too. It was only a part of the show, a **trick** to make the picture more real. We were all **afraid** for one second, and then we felt **safe** again.

After the show there was a small laboratory next to the hall, and the guide let us do a short **experiment**. We mixed two harmless **chemicals** with water and made a small “volcano”. Nobody knew the **secret** of the red color, and she told us only at the end: it was a special powder. It was a real **adventure** for a morning, and we **laughed** a lot.

A Morning at the Planetarium

Day 1 · Reading (2 of 2)

What to do: After reading: which paragraphs were easy, which were hard? Which blue words did you know already?

Then we went to the **library** of the planetarium. It was full of books about space, and we could borrow some. I took a book about the Moon and my friend took one about the stars. Our teacher said that every student must write a short report. I did not want to **fail**, so I started that same evening.

That night I could not sleep. I looked out of the window, and for the first time in my life I really saw the night sky. Some stars were bright and some were not. I thought about the guide's words: there are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on Earth. I felt small, but not afraid. I was **clever** enough to know that I did not know much, and that was a good feeling.

On the way back the bus was quiet at first. Then a boy asked: "Do you think there is life on other planets?" Everybody had an opinion. A girl said yes, a boy said no, and our teacher said: "Maybe." We argued for the whole way home, and nobody was angry. It was the best conversation of the day.

Later I read that the first modern planetarium opened in Germany in 1925. A special machine with many lenses threw the stars onto a round roof, and the audience could see the whole sky from a chair. Today there are thousands of planetariums in the world. They are very useful for cities, because in a big city the lights hide most of the stars.

Next week we are going to show our reports in class. We will draw a map of the planets, we will make a model of Mars and we will describe our trip. Maybe a few of us will be astronomers one day. The trip was only one morning, but we are going to remember it for a very long time.

The 20 words

Day 1 · Vocabulary table · Topic: Review: fear, science and space

What to do: Book: 4000 EEW 1, Unit 1–3, pages 9, 15 and 21. Copy the words you do not know into the copybook.

Word	Meaning	По-русски	Example
afraid adj.	full of fear	испуганный; бояться	My little brother is afraid of the dark.
angry adj.	feeling that you want to shout	сердитый, злой	Mom is angry because my room is a mess.
arrive v.	get to a place	прибывать, приезжать	The bus arrives at 8 o'clock.
clever adj.	quick to learn and understand	умный, сообразительный	She is a clever girl: she solves every puzzle.
hide v.	go where nobody can see you	прятать(ся)	The children hide behind the trees.
safe adj.	not in danger	безопасный, в безопасности	Wear a helmet and be safe.
trick n.	a clever act to fool someone	фокус, хитрость	The magician shows a great trick.
adventure n.	an exciting or dangerous experience	приключение	Camping in the mountains is a great adventure.
chemical n.	a substance used in or made by science	химическое вещество	Don't touch these chemicals!
experiment n.	a scientific test to find something out	опыт, эксперимент	We do an experiment in science class.
laugh v.	make the sound that shows you think something is funny	смеяться	We laugh at funny videos.
loud adj.	with a lot of sound	громкий	The music is too loud!
nervous adj.	a little afraid or worried	нервный, взволнованный	I am nervous before a test.
secret n./adj.	something that only a few people know	секрет; секретный	Can you keep a secret?
alien n.	a creature from another planet	инопланетянин	The alien came from another planet.
cloud n.	a white or grey mass in the sky	облако	The spaceship flew through the clouds.
describe v.	say what something is like	описывать	Describe your best friend.
fail v.	not succeed	провалить, не суметь	He failed the test because he didn't study.
library n.	a place with books you can borrow	библиотека	We read books in the school library.
planet n.	a big round object that goes around a star	планета	Mars is the red planet.

More on the topic

Day 1 · Topic: Review: fear, science and space · more words

What to do: Choose 5 collocations to learn. Use the reserve words when a student already knows the main ones.

Collocations: words that go together

be afraid of…	бояться…
play a trick on…	разыграть…
do an experiment	проводить эксперимент
keep a secret	хранить тайну
go on an adventure	отправиться в приключение
describe a picture	описать картину
fail an exam	провалить экзамен
a loud noise	громкий шум
feel nervous	нервничать
arrive at / in	прибыть в
feel safe	чувствовать себя в безопасности
hide from…	прятаться от…

Phrasal verbs

find out	узнать	We found out the secret at the end.
turn off	выключить	She turned off the lights.
run away	убежать	The boy ran away.
calm down	успокоиться	Calm down: it is only a show.
look up	смотреть вверх; искать в словаре	We looked up at the stars.
give up	сдаться	Do not give up.

Reserve words: for students who know the 20 already, or if you prefer another word

planetarium	планетарий	**report**	отчёт
astronomer	астроном	**trip**	поездка
telescope	телескоп	**guide**	гид
volcano	вулкан	**brave**	храбрый
powder	порошок	**model**	модель

What to read next · 4000 Essential English Words

This week: revise **Book 1, Units 1–3**: the word pages 8–9, 14–15, 20–21 and the stories “The Lion and the Rabbit”, “The Laboratory” and “The Report”. Next: **Unit 4, “The Dog’s Bell”**, pages 26–31.